

THE NEW SPACE ODYSSEY

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INDIA'S \$13-BILLION SPACETECH SECTOR
AIMS TO HIT \$40 BILLION BY 2030. BUT WITH
JUST 1.3% OF GLOBAL CAPITAL AND NO MAJOR
EXITS YET, CAN IT TRULY SCALE?

BY **PALAK AGARWAL**



ENGALURU-BASED PIXXEL Space is a rarity in India's \$13 billion spacetechnology industry. For one thing, Pixxel has received investor funding in a testament to the potential of the company. It was picked by National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA) in 2024 to provide earth observation data on climate change, biodiversity and agriculture to its \$476 million Commercial SmallSat Data Acquisition (CSDA) Program.

The company, founded in 2019 by Awais Ahmed and Kshitij Khandelwal, is also one of the few to actually earn revenue from its business. Chief Executive Officer Ahmed, who has a master's degree in mathematics from BITS Pilani, says Pixxel is still an